QUESTION 11: ESCALATION TICKET TEMPLATE

DG Interns Hub Cybersecurity Internship – Week 5 Submission

Student Name: Gunjan **Track:** SOC Analyst Tier 1 **Topic:** L1-to-L2 Incident Escalation Ticket Standard & Sample

1. STANDARD L1-TO-L2 ESCALATION TICKET FIELDS

An escalation ticket serves as the official operational bridge between Tier 1 (Triage) and Tier 2 (Incident Response). It must be complete and unambiguous so that L2 responders can act immediately without re-investigating basic details.

Template Field Name	Field Description & Analyst Guidance
Alert ID	Unique identification code generated by the SIEM or ticketing platform (e.g., INC-2026-9941).
Alert Name & Severity	Official rule title triggered (e.g., Potential Brute Force) and assigned severity (Critical/High/Med/Low).
Detection Time	Exact UTC timestamp when the security event was logged by the sensor.
Source IP / Destination IP	Network address of the attacking entity and IP of the internal target system.
Affected Host & User	Hostname, server tag, and targeted user account domain/ID.
Alert Description	Concise summary of the abnormal event and triggered detection parameters.
Indicators (IOCs/IOAs)	Observed malicious file hashes, suspicious command-line parameters, or external IPs.
MITRE ATT&CK Mapping	Corresponding Tactic name and Technique ID (e.g., T1110 - Brute Force).
Investigation Steps Done	Chronological list of all verification checks carried out by the L1 analyst.
Threat Intel Findings	Reputation score and lookup results from VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB, or AlienVault OTX.
Analyst Assessment	L1 conclusion explaining why this is a confirmed True Positive threat.
Reason for Escalation	Explicit explanation of why Tier 2 intervention, containment, or advanced forensics is needed.
Recommended Actions	Suggested immediate response steps (e.g., host isolation, account disablement, firewall block).

2. FULLY COMPLETED SAMPLE ESCALATION TICKET

[HYPOTHETICAL SAMPLE TICKET - FOR TRAINING & SUBMISSION PURPOSES ONLY]

Alert ID:	INC-2026-48902
Alert Name:	Multiple Failed Logons Followed by Successful Authentication (Brute Force Success)
Alert Severity:	HIGH
Detection Time:	2026-10-31 14:22:05 UTC

Source IP:	`198.51.100.89` (External - Unknown Host ISP)
Destination IP:	`10.0.3.45` (Internal Subnet - DMZ)
Affected Host:	`FIN-SERVER-04` (Production Finance Database Server)
Affected User:	`corp\a_miller` (Senior Finance Manager)
Alert Description:	SIEM triggered after detecting 112 failed logon attempts (Event ID 4625) within 2 minutes targeting account `a_miller`, immediately followed by 1 successful logon (Event ID 4624) from the same external source IP.
Observed Indicators:	Source IP: `198.51.100.89` | Logon Type: 10 (Remote Desktop / RDP)
MITRE ATT&CK:	Credential Access: Brute Force (T1110) / Remote Services (T1021)
Investigation Steps:	1. Queried SIEM logs for Event ID 4625 for host `FIN-SERVER-04`. Confirmed 112 failures between 14:18 UTC and 14:21 UTC. 2. Queried Event ID 4624. Confirmed successful RDP authentication at 14:22:01 UTC from IP `198.51.100.89`. 3. Checked AbuseIPDB: IP `198.51.100.89` has an Abuse Confidence Score of 99% (reported 210 times for RDP brute force). 4. Contacted user `a_miller` via internal chat; user confirmed they are on annual leave and NOT attempting to log in.
Threat Intel:	AbuseIPDB Score: 99% Malicious | VirusTotal: Flagged by 14 security vendors.
Analyst Assessment:	High-confidence **True Positive** active compromise. Attacker successfully brute-forced RDP access to a production finance server holding sensitive company assets.
Reason Escalated:	Active unauthorized session established on critical server. L2 privileges required for host network isolation, session termination, and memory dump acquisition.
Recommended Action:	1. Isolate host `FIN-SERVER-04` from the network via EDR. 2. Terminate active RDP session for user `a_miller` and temporarily disable AD account. 3. Block IP `198.51.100.89` at perimeter edge firewall.
Current Status:	**ESCALATED TO TIER 2 IR QUEUE**

3. TERMINOLOGY & REFERENCES

Logon Type 10: Windows authentication event type indicating an interactive logon via Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP). **Active Breach Containment:** Emergency actions taken to restrict an adversary's access once a compromise is confirmed.

References:

• CISA Incident Escalation & Reporting Guidelines: **https://www.cisa.gov/**
• NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 2 Computer Security Incident Handling Guide: **https://csrc.nist.gov/**